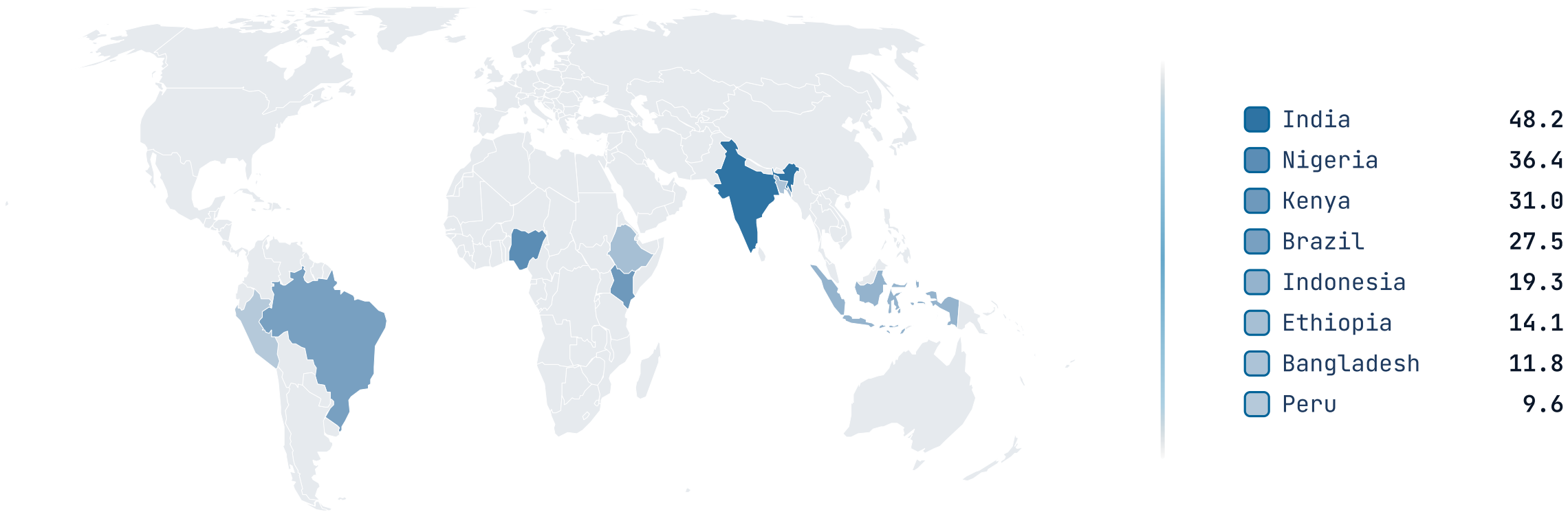


EVIDENCE · SPATIAL · SERIES

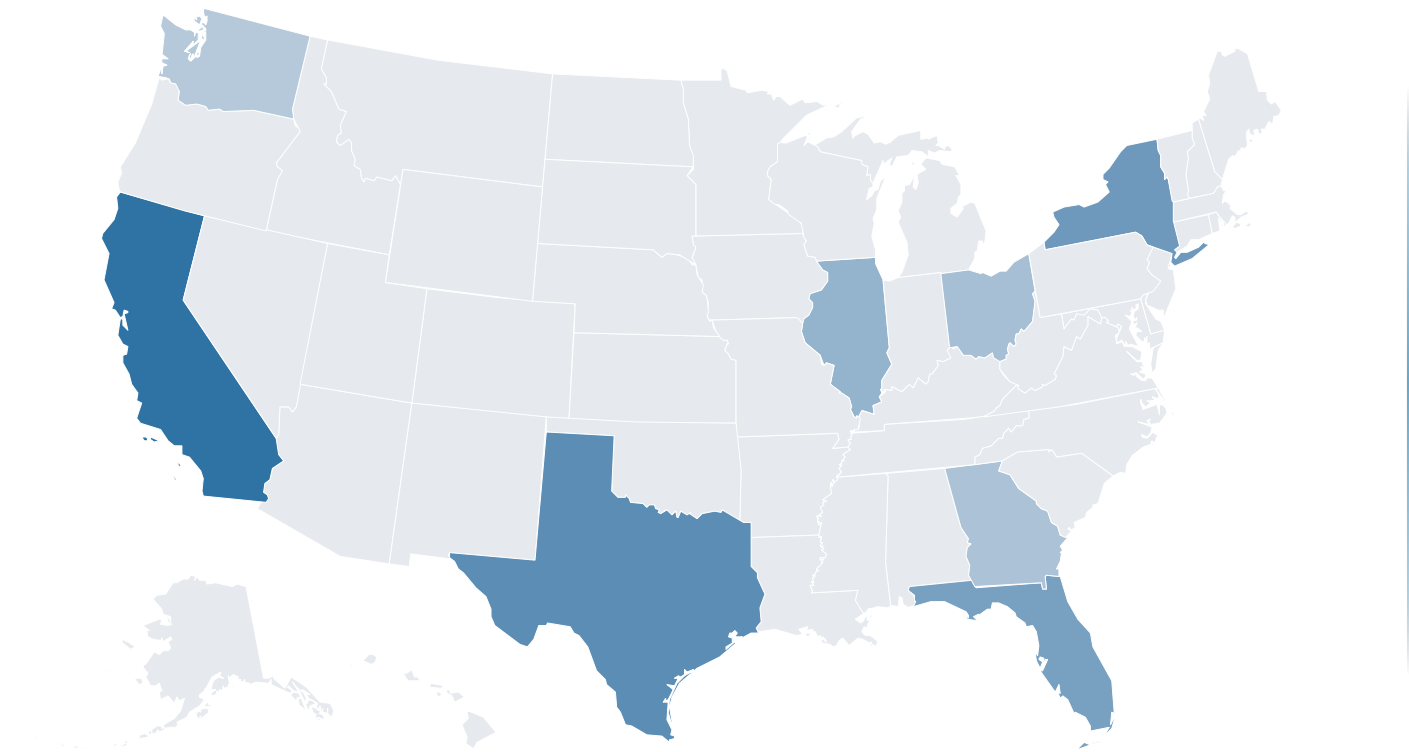
map

A world-countries (or US-states) basemap that fills regions by value (choropleth) or category (highlight) so the audience leaves knowing where.

The map fills regions by value.

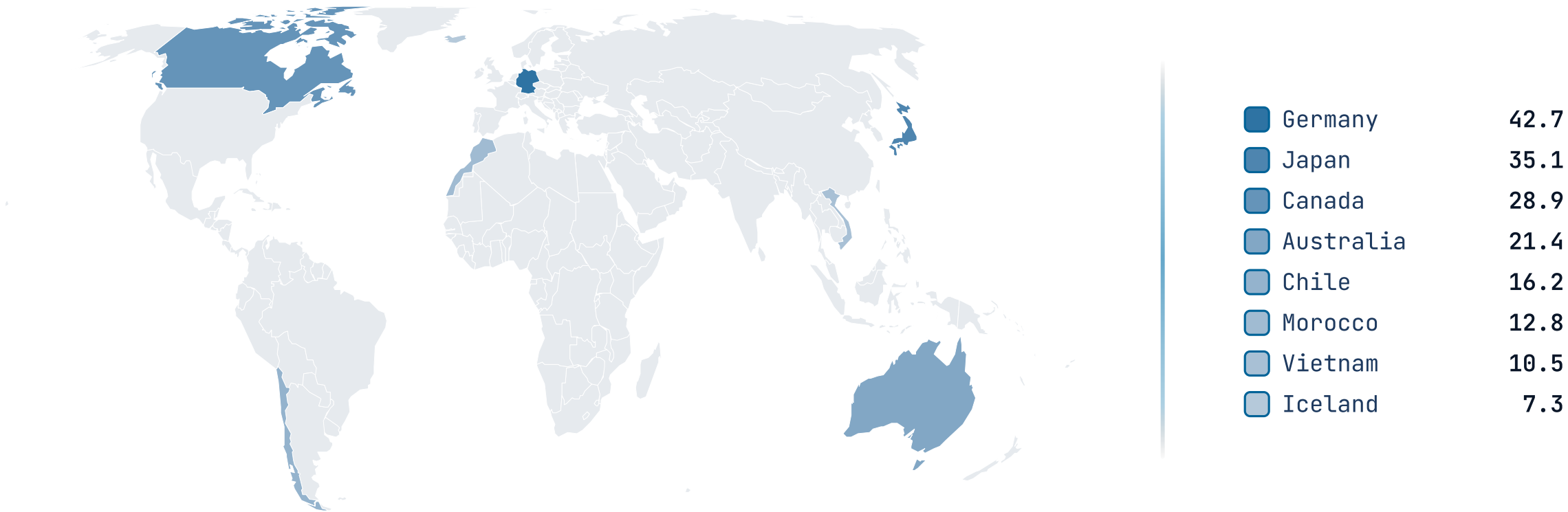


us swaps in the US-states basemap.

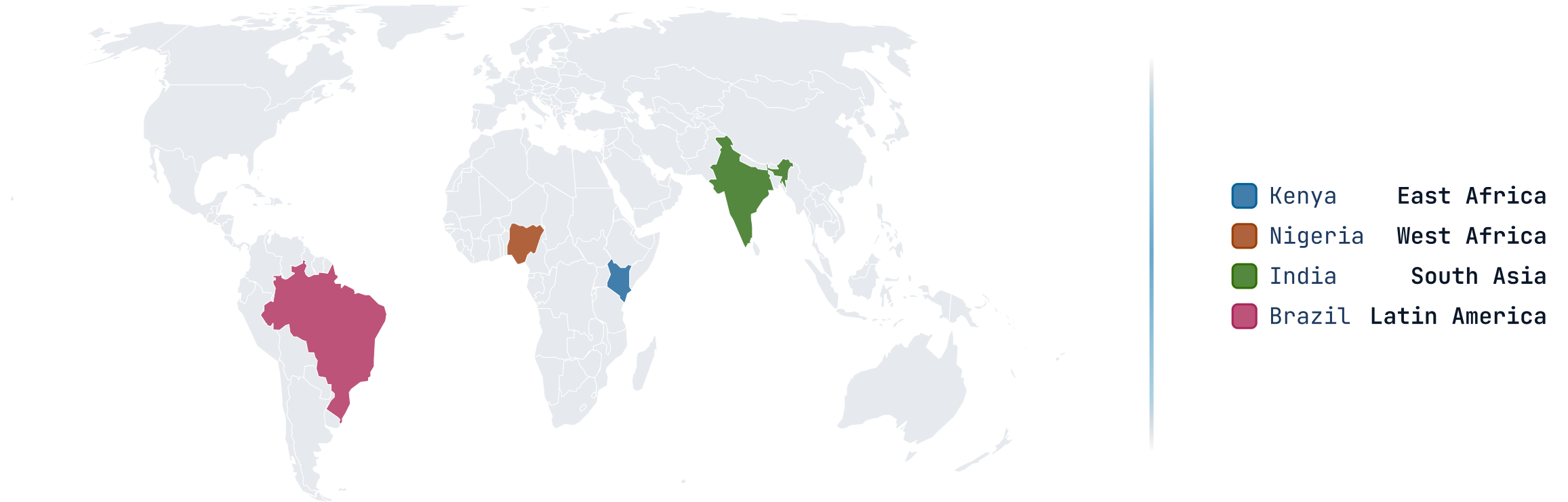


California	48.2
Texas	36.4
New York	31.0
Florida	27.5
Illinois	19.3
Ohio	14.1
Georgia	11.8
Washington	9.6

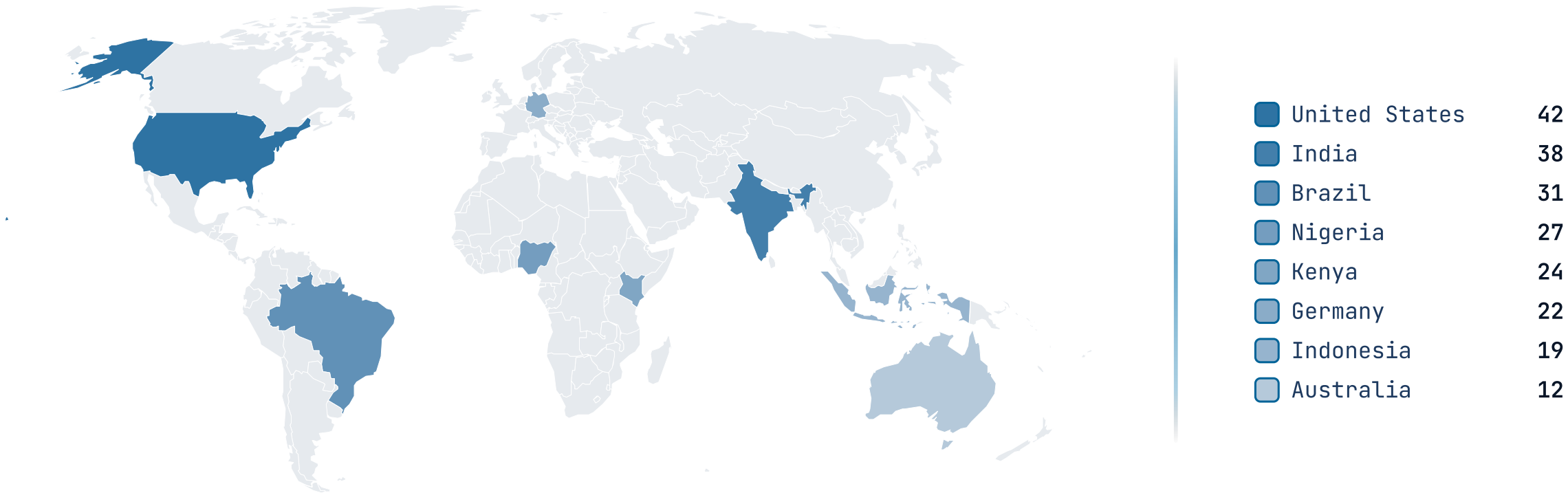
The same engine, pinned to the world basemap.



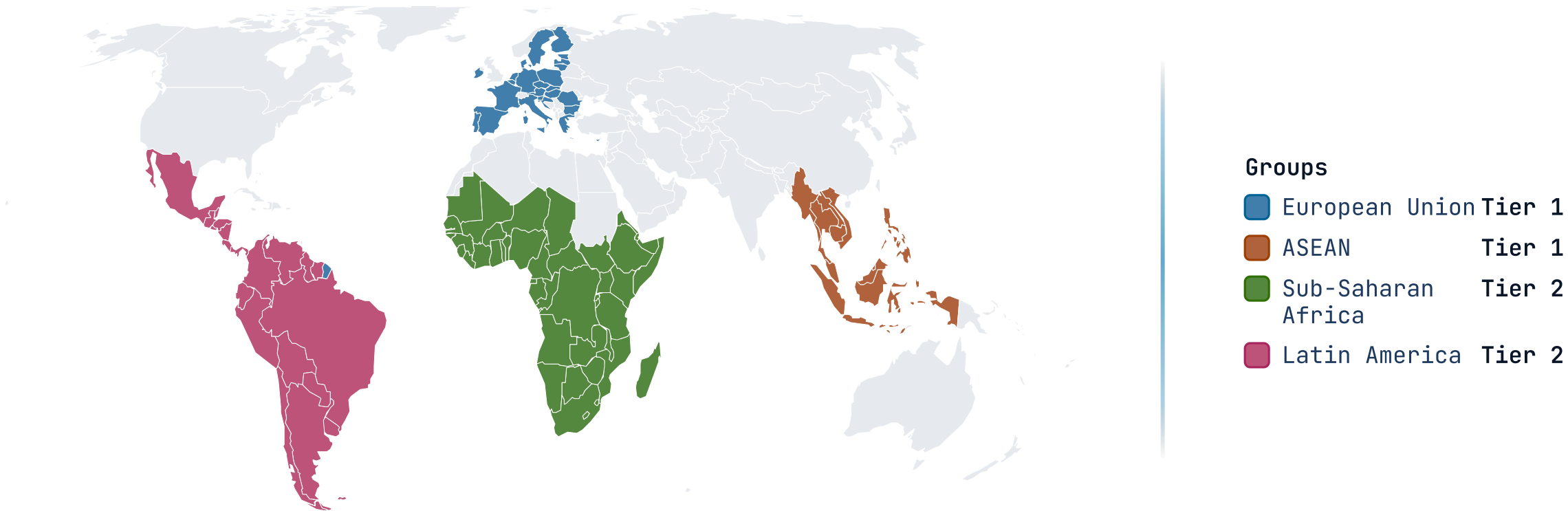
highlight fills by category, not value.



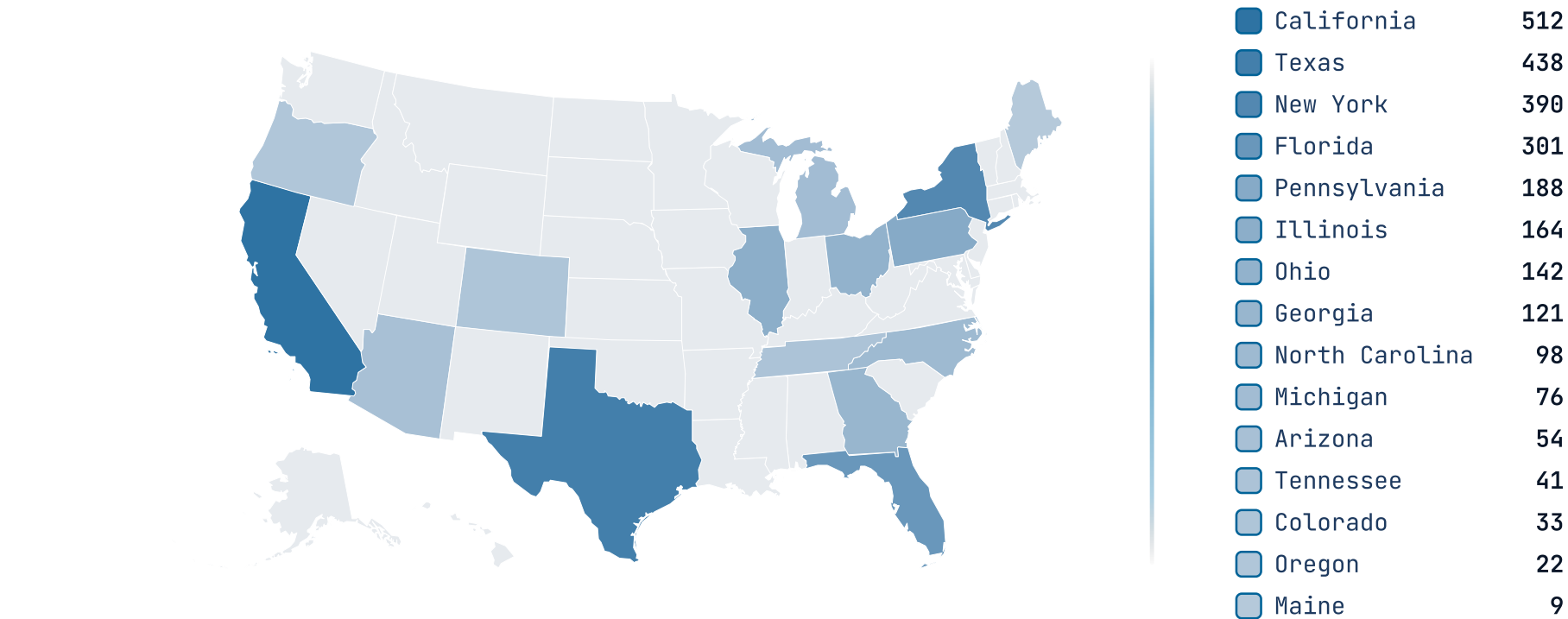
robinson swaps the projection.



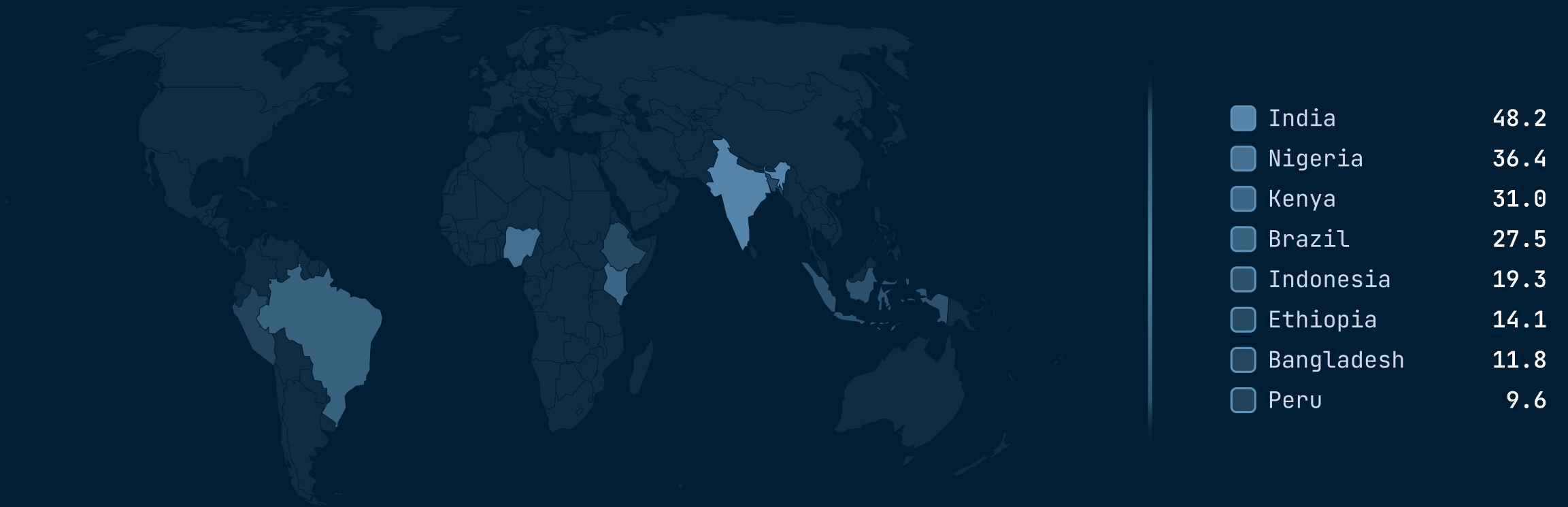
grouped fills whole blocs at once.



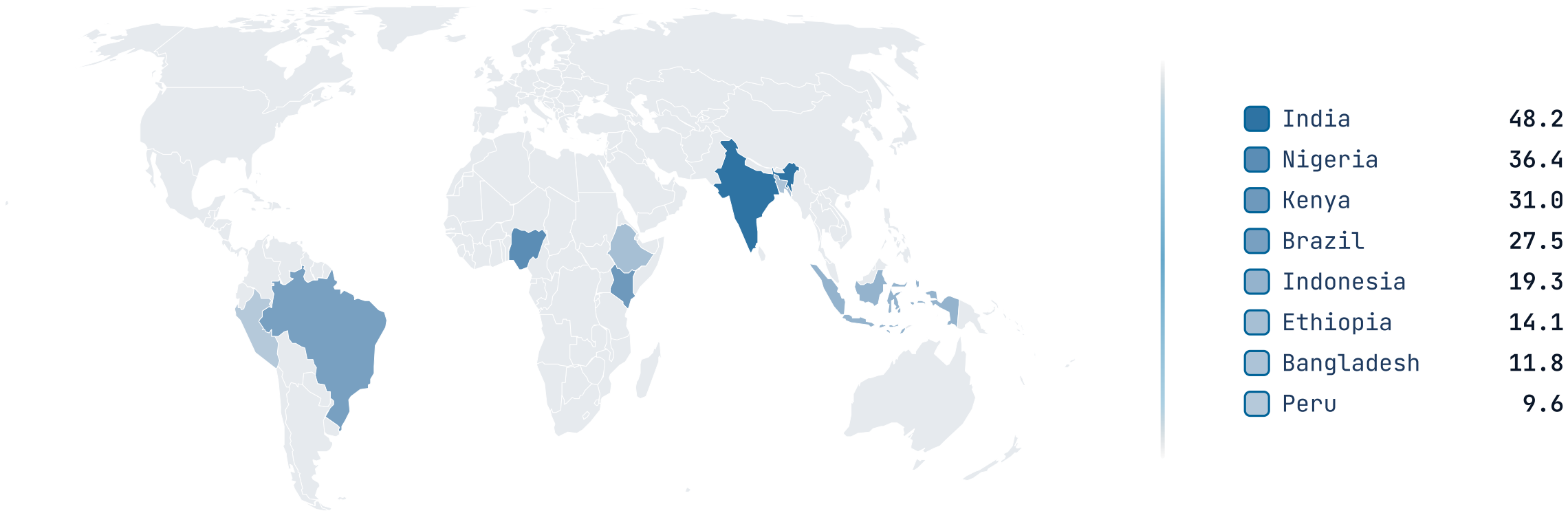
A wide spread across fifteen states.



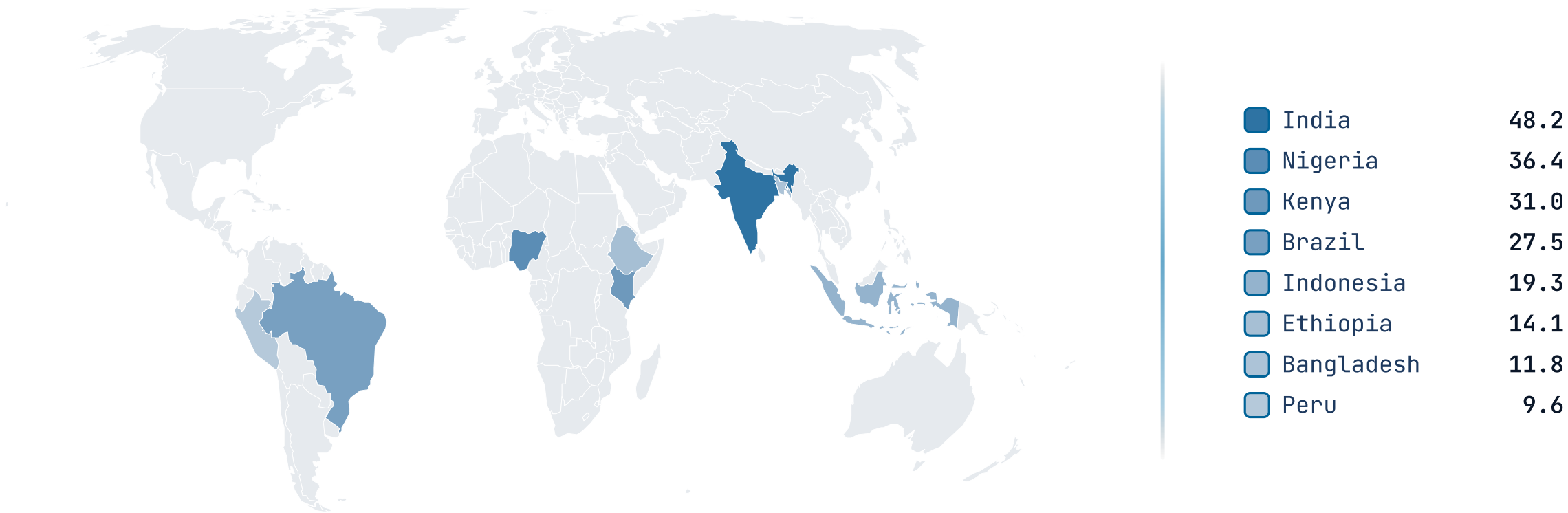
The map fills regions by value.



The map fills regions by value.



The map fills regions by value.



When NOT to reach for map.

A map as decoration

If the regions aren't the comparison — you just want a US-shaped graphic behind some numbers — drop the basemap. An `image` scrim or a `stats` row carries headline figures without implying the geography is the message.

Too many shades to read

A choropleth past a dozen distinct values asks the eye to rank colors it can't separate. Bucket the values, switch to `highlight` for a categorical read, or lead with a `progress` ranking and keep the map as support.

Sub-region precision the basemap doesn't have

The basemaps draw US states and world countries — not counties, districts, sub-national regions, or city pins, and the world cut (110m) omits the smallest city-states. If the story lives below that line, a labeled `image` of the real map serves better than forcing it onto the basemap.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`progress` — the regions are really a ranking — labeled bars compare magnitudes faster than shades

`stats` — a few headline figures with no geography to place them on

`piechart` — regional shares of a single whole rather than a value per place

`image` — the geography needs detail (counties, cities, routes) the basemap can't draw